

Deadly embrace

The emerald tree boa is not venomous; it uses its powerful muscles to squeeze its prey to death. It is well camouflaged among the leaves and branches—its bright green skin helps it hide from enemies and allows it to move close to its prey before it strikes.



Emerald tree boa
(*Corallus caninus*)
Length: up to 8 ft 10 in (2.7 m)

Nutcracker beak

The scarlet macaw is one of the largest South American parrots. Its strong, hooked beak has scissorlike edges that work like massive nutcrackers. Its beak can even split open the shells of Brazil nuts. The macaw often uses one of its feet to hold food up to its mouth.

Scarlet macaw (*Ara macao*)
Total length: up to 35 in (89 cm)



Red piranha
(*Serrasalmus nattereri*)
Length: up to 1 ft 8 in (50 cm)



Razor teeth

Piranhas have powerful jaws with razor-sharp teeth. They scavenge on carcasses of large animals, but can also kill small prey.

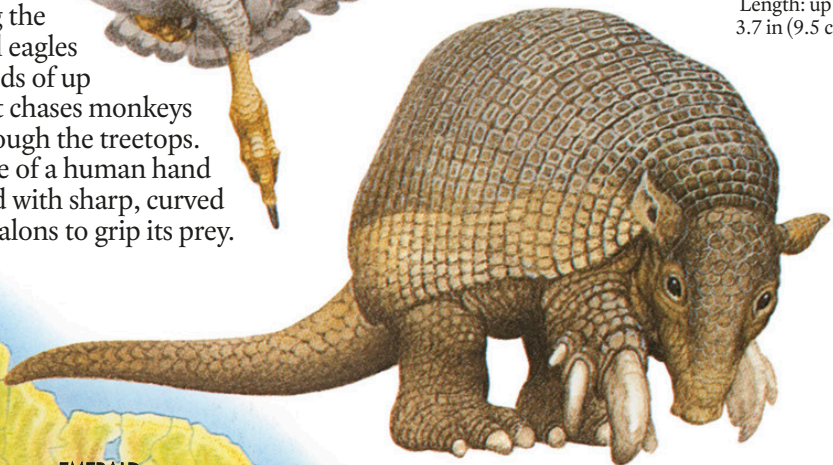
Harpy eagle
(*Harpia harpyja*)
Length: up to 3 ft 5 in (1 m)



Biggest eagle

The harpy eagle is among the largest and most powerful eagles in the world. It flies at speeds of up to 50 mph (80 kph) as it chases monkeys and other animals through the treetops. Its feet are about the size of a human hand and are tipped with sharp, curved talons to grip its prey.

Giant armadillo
(*Priodontes maximus*)
Body length: up to 3 ft 3 in (1 m)



Ruby-topaz hummingbird
(*Chrysolampis mosquitos*)
Length: up to 3.7 in (9.5 cm)



Hovering jewels

The ruby-topaz hummingbird hovers in front of the forest flowers as it probes for nectar with its long bill. Its wings beat as fast as 80 times per second. It can hover in one place, fly backward, and reach speeds of up to 40 mph (65 kph).

Largest claws

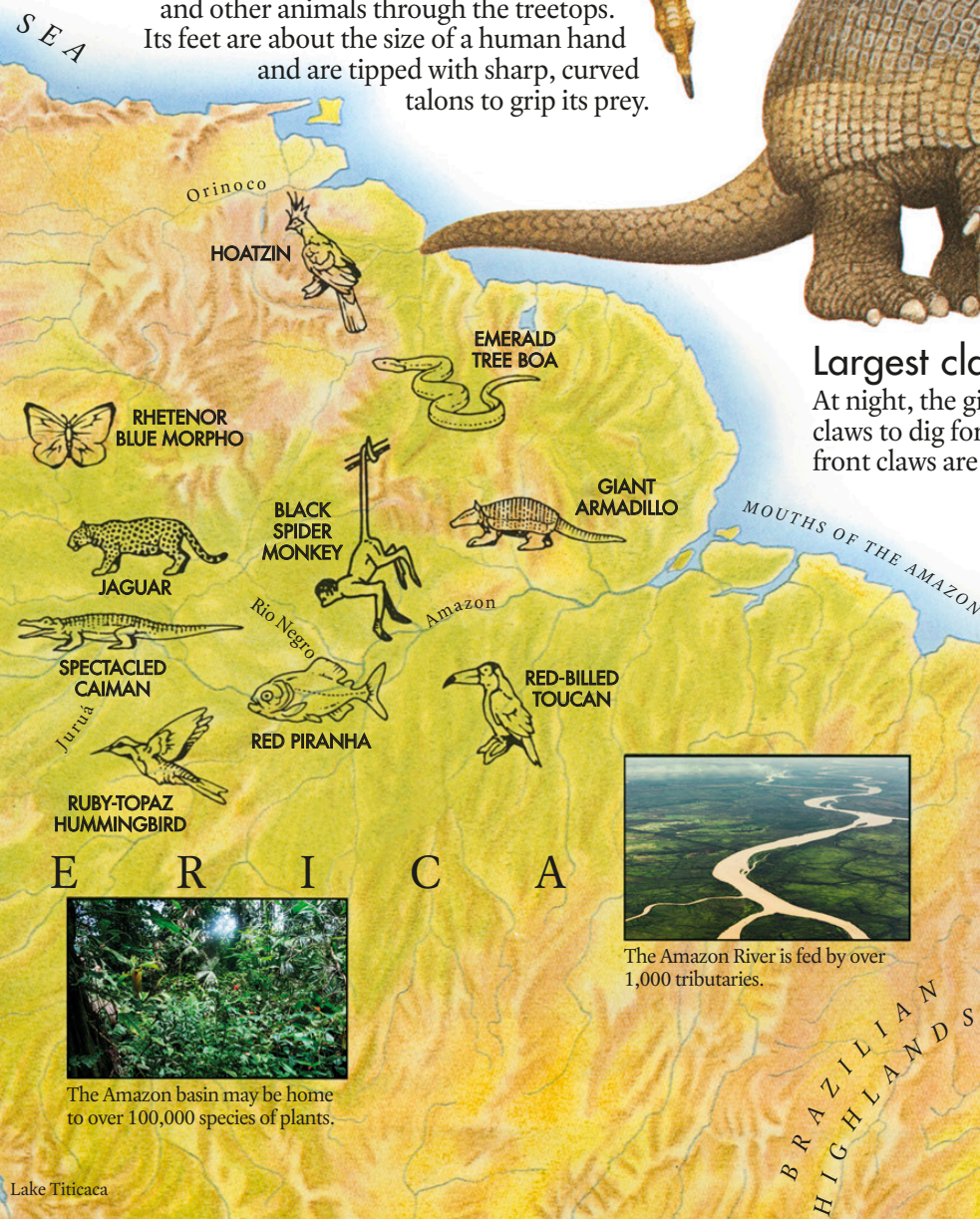
At night, the giant armadillo uses its curved claws to dig for worms, ants, and termites. Its front claws are the largest of any living animal.



Brown-throated three-toed sloth
(*Bradypus variegatus*)
Length: up to 1 ft 9 in (54 cm)

Upside-down life

The sloth uses its long, hooklike claws to hang upside down from branches. It may stay in the same tree for years. Its fur grows down from its stomach to its back so that rain runs off more easily. In the rainy season, the sloth turns green because of the microscopic green algae that live on its fur.



The Amazon River is fed by over 1,000 tributaries.



The Amazon basin may be home to over 100,000 species of plants.

